

COMMON MISTAKES IN THE GROUP PROJECT

This document outlines common mistakes that were made in the group project and explains how these mistakes were penalised by the markers. The line/lines that are applicable from the rubric are given in brackets at the end of each mistake.

Please note: Many of you lost many marks because of vagueness. It is not enough to just name/consider the elements, you must have sufficient detail to attain the marks.

PART A

Section 1

1. You should not state what the solution is in this section. This is a problem statement, not a solution statement. If you did this the highest mark you could for this section was 2/3 (BUT Problem statement not comprehensive/specific).
2. The implementation of the ID technique is not clear or correct. If it is unclear, the highest mark obtainable is 1/3 Problem statement not comprehensive/specific).

Section 2

1. You target market description is vague or not applicable to your project. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 1/3 (All elements completed but there is a lack of coherence between elements or insufficient detail).
2. You did not have at least 4 competitors on your marketing map. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 1/3 (All elements completed but there is a lack of coherence between elements or insufficient detail.)
3. A marketing map with two axes and four quadrants. Many of you did not indicate the quadrants. If you did this the highest mark you could get for this section was 1/3 (Errors in the marketing map).
4. Incorrect implementation of Porter's 5 Forces – you need to indicate and explain the LEVEL of the threat imposed by the individual forces. Many of you used this technique to discuss the product or target market and not the threat of the forces. Maximum mark obtainable is 1/3 (All elements completed but there is a lack of coherence between elements or insufficient detail).
5. You did not give references for market analysis. It is not enough to have a reference list in the document, you need to indicate in this section of the document where you got your information. If you did not do this the highest mark that you could get for this section was 2/3 (Indepth market analysis evident with references as proof).

The inflation rate ranged from 4.38% - 6.09% from 2014 to 2019 (Statista, 2020). According to Statista (2020), the inflation rate for 2021 and 2022 is predicted to be 5.3%. This is the inflation rate that was used in this report

The picture above is an example of in-text referencing. The references are circled. This is what was required for you to get 3/3 for the sections that require evidence of market research.

Section 3

1. Having technical performance measures (TMPs) that are not considered to be TMPs. For example the TMP is yes/no. TPMS are something you can measure (hence the word measures), so having a yes/no is wrong. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 1/3 (It is clear little thought went into it).
2. Confused the objective tree with a work breakdown structure. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 2/3 (Coherence between SORs, tree, and TPMs. Enough detail in both elements).

Section 4

1. You did not discuss all the primary and secondary activities. If you did this you got 0/3 for this section (Any one of the primary or support activities are not discussed.)
 - Primary activities
 - Inbound logistics
 - Operations
 - Outbound logistics
 - Marketing and Sales
 - Service (many of you did not discuss this one)
 - Secondary activities
 - Procurement
 - Technological development
 - Human resources (HR) management
 - Infrastructure
2. If the discussions are vague, general and do not show insight, you received a maximum mark of 2/3 (All activities are described. Coherence between the value chain design and operational requirements).

Section 5

1. Your combined network diagram had more than 20 tasks (more than 20 tasks)
2. You did not indicate the critical path. If you did not indicate the critical path you got 0/3 (Any element incomplete).
3. You did not have a single start node or end node in the network diagram. If you did this, the highest mark that you could receive was 1/3 (BUT Errors in network diagram).
4. Node transitions entered or exited a node from the top or bottom of the node. If you did this, the highest mark that you could receive was 1/3 (BUT Errors in network diagram).
5. You did not have at least 5 risks or you had more than 10 risks. If you did this you got 0/3 (OR less than 5 or more than 10 risks).
6. You did not indicate the risk's likelihood and consequence level. If you did this, the highest mark that you could receive was 1/3 (OR Errors in risk matrix).

7. You did not give references for your risk matrix and risk mitigation strategies. It is not enough to have a reference list in the document, you need to indicate in this section of the document where you got your information (as shown in the picture below). If you did not do this the highest mark that you could get for this section was 2/3 (Risk matrix and mitigation strategies shows evidence of market research).

Section 6

1. Errors in the MARR and NPV calculations. If you did this the highest mark that you could receive for this section was 2/3 (Slight errors in calculations allowed.). Depending on how significant the errors were, some of you received 1/3 (Gross errors in determining the MARR or NPV OR Errors in recommendations).
2. You did not interpret the NPV. If you did not interpret the NPV, meaning to give recommendations regarding the financial feasibility of the project, an element was missing from this section and you received 0/3 (Any of the elements incomplete or sloppily executed).
3. There was no link between the individual budgets in the three Part Bs and this section. If you did this the highest mark you could get for this section was 1/3 (Not coherent with Part B's).
4. You did not show and substantiate how you determine the MARR for you project. If you did the you got 0/3 for this section (Any of the elements incomplete or sloppily executed).
5. You did not submit the workbook. We needed the workbook to confirm that you did the calculations for this section correctly, so if you did not submit it, we could not check you work. If you did this you got 0/3 for this section (Any of the elements incomplete or sloppily executed).
6. Your present worth analysis in your document and in your workbook did not correspond. If you did this you got 0/3 (Any of the elements incomplete or sloppily executed).
7. You did not describe and quantify the differences between the worst, most likely and best case scenarios. If you did this you got a maximum mark of 2/3.
8. You did not give references for your MARR determination. It is not enough to have a reference list in the document, you need to indicate in this section of the document where you got your information (as shown in the picture below). If you did not do this the highest mark that you could get for this section was 2/3 (Market research to define the MARR is evident).
9. You have many of the original values from the Slime Factory spreadsheet in your workbook. This is partial similarity, which could be considered copying (plagiarism). We decided to give you the benefit of the doubt, but if you did this the highest mark you could get for this section was 1.5/3.

Professionalism

1. Many of you exceeded the page limit. If you did this you got 0/3 for professionalism (Page limit exceeded)
2. General mistakes
 - Text not justified – this is accepted practise in professional and academic writing

- Having undefined acronyms
- Using different texts and text sizes (within the same paragraph/section/etc.)
- Spelling mistakes
- Grammar mistakes
- Having extremely long sentences – this is difficult to read.
- Using contractions (isn't instead of is not)
- Writing in first person
- No tables and figure headings
- Terrible colour choices
- Unreadable figures

PART B

Section 1

(Please note we were lenient in this section)

1. You described the business and the product/service, rather than describing your system. You were supposed to describe the logistics, operations or marketing and sales systems in this section. If you did this, the highest mark that you could get for this section was 1/3 (Description is present but it doesn't highlight key characteristics).
2. You did not discuss the key characteristics of the systems as explained in the class notes. You did not have to have all of them, but you had to at least consider some of them. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 2/3 (Concise description highlighting key characteristics). The characteristics as given in the class notes are:
 - Production/operations
 - Push vs pull system
 - Operations performance metrics
 1. Efficiency
 2. Productivity/ Throughput
 3. Cycle time
 4. Turnaround time
 5. Error rate
 6. Cost effectiveness
 - Constant work-in-progress (CONWIP)
 - Logistics system
 - Logistics decision triangle
 1. Lead time
 2. Reliability
 3. Cost
 - Centralised vs decentralised networks
 - Inventory management
 - Warehouse and distribution centres
 - Transportation management
 - Marketing and sales system

- Marketing mix using 4Ps or 7Ps
 - Three-levels of a product
 1. The core benefit
 2. The tangible product/service
 3. The augmented product/service
 - Elements of customer service
 1. Time
 2. Dependability
 3. Communication
 4. Convenience
3. If you gave a good description of your system that highlighted how it was supposed to function but did not specifically described the characteristics given above, you could have still gotten 2/3 (Concise description highlighting key characteristics). This is where the leniency was applied.

Section 2

1. A scope statement should consists of three elements:
 - Specific deliverables
 - Budget
 - Completion date/due date

If you did not include all three elements, the highest mark you could get for this section was 1/3 (project scope is ambiguous).
2. You gave the scope statement for this business as a whole, rather than for your system. If you did this, and all other elements in this section were completed on standard, the highest mark you could receive for this section was 2/3.
3. You had all three elements of the scope, bit your deliverables vague and not specific. If you did this the highest mark you could receive for this section was 1/3 (Project scope is ambiguous). Here is an example for the marketing and sales system:
 - Vague: To advertise on the University of Pretoria campuses
 - Specific: To distribute between at least 10 000 flyers to students studying at the University of Pretoria and hang up 2 000 posters on the University of Pretoria campuses.
4. You did not indicate the internal and external stakeholders, you only had stakeholders. If you did this the highest mark that you could receive for this section was 1/3 (OR Stakeholder analysis is superficial).

Section 3

1. You had less than three phases. You were told multiple times that you had to have at least three phases and that the first phase should be the “start-up” phase. If you did this the maximum mark that you could get for this section was 2/3 (Minimal errors on network diagram).
2. Your phases, work breakdown structure and network diagram must be coherent. If this was not the case, the highest mark you could receive was 1\3 (There is a mismatch between WBS and network diagram.)

3. You must indicate the critical path – if you did not do this, this element is missing and you received 0/3 for this section (Any of the elements missing or sloppily executed).
4. You must indicate forward pass, backward pass and float. Many of you forgot to indicate the float. Leaving any of these three elements out means that there are elements missing and you received 0/3 for this section (Any of the elements missing or sloppily executed).
5. Errors in the forward pass, backwards pass and float calculations. Many of you made silly mistakes in your calculations. Before appealing your marks, double and triple check all your calculations. If you did this the highest mark that you could get was 2/3 (Minimal errors on network diagram). Depending on how many mistakes you made/ how bad the calculations were, some of you got 1/3 (There are significant errors in the network diagram or in the float, slack, forward and backward pass calculations).
6. Other errors on the network diagram
 - There is not a single start node
 - There is not a single end node
 - Transitions enter/ exit a node from the top or bottom of the node.If you made one of these mistake, the highest mark that you could get for this section was 2/3 (Minimal errors on network diagram).
7. You had all your phases in your network diagram. We did not deduct marks for this but take note if you have to redo the project that you must only have the first phase on your network diagram.

Section 4

1. You need to have all the activities that are in the network diagram in the set-up budget. Even if the values were zero. You need to show that you understand that there is a link between the activities in the first phase and the set-up budget. If you did not do this, the highest mark you could get for this section was 1/3 (Errors in compiling the budget).
2. You did not include references for your resources and costs. It is not enough to do research and to have a reference list, you need to reference how you determined your human resources and cost in this section of the report. If you did not do this, you **could not** get 3/3 for this section (Evidence of market research to determine requirements)
3. You did not have any overhead costs, this is a fundamental of a set-up budget. This you did this you got 0/3 (Any of the elements missing or sloppily executed).
4. You did not explicitly list the human resource requirements. If you did not do this, the highest mark you could get for this section was 2/3 (Materials/equipment adequately considered.).

Section 5

1. You did not use the correct format:

Month	Selling price	Sales volume ('000)	Monthly revenue	Quarterly revenue	Labour (per unit)	Materials (per unit)	Electricity (per unit)	Monthly COGS	Quarterly COGS	Monthly gross profit	Quarterly gross profit
1	R 450,00	5	R 2 250 000,00		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 25,00	R 1 900 000,00		R 350 000,00	
2	R 450,90	5	R 2 254 500,00		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 25,00	R 1 900 000,00		R 354 500,00	
3	R 451,80	8	R 3 614 414,40	R 8 118 914,40	R 55,00	R 300,00	R 25,00	R 3 040 000,00	R 6 840 000,00	R 574 414,40	R 1 278 914,40
4	R 452,71	10	R 4 527 054,04		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 25,00	R 3 800 000,00		R 727 054,04	
5	R 453,61	13	R 5 896 940,59		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 25,00	R 4 940 000,00		R 956 940,59	
6	R 454,52	19	R 8 635 842,68	R 19 059 837,31	R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 7 267 500,00	R 16 007 500,00	R 1 368 342,68	R 3 052 337,31
7	R 455,43	15	R 6 831 406,08		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 5 737 500,00		R 1 093 906,08	
8	R 456,34	50	R 22 816 896,31		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 19 125 000,00		R 3 691 896,31	
9	R 457,25	50	R 22 862 530,11	R 52 510 832,50	R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 19 125 000,00	R 43 987 500,00	R 3 737 530,11	R 8 523 332,50
10	R 458,17	50	R 22 908 255,17		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 19 125 000,00		R 3 783 255,17	
11	R 459,08	100	R 45 908 143,35		R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 38 250 000,00		R 7 658 143,35	
12	R 460,00	110	R 50 599 955,60	R 119 416 354,12	R 55,00	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 42 075 000,00	R 99 450 000,00	R 8 524 955,60	R 19 966 354,12
13	R 460,92	120	R 55 310 351,47		R 58,30	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 46 296 000,00		R 9 014 351,47	
14	R 461,84	120	R 55 420 972,17		R 58,30	R 300,00	R 27,50	R 46 296 000,00		R 9 124 972,17	
15	R 462,77	120	R 55 531 814,12	R 166 263 137,76	R 58,30	R 300,00	R 29,70	R 46 560 000,00	R 139 152 000,00	R 8 971 814,12	R 27 111 137,76
16	R 463,69	120	R 55 642 877,74		R 58,30	R 300,00	R 29,70	R 46 560 000,00		R 9 082 877,74	
17	R 464,62	120	R 55 754 163,50		R 58,30	R 300,00	R 29,70	R 46 560 000,00		R 9 194 163,50	
18	R 465,55	120	R 55 865 671,83	R 167 262 713,07	R 58,30	R 300,00	R 29,70	R 46 560 000,00	R 139 680 000,00	R 9 305 671,83	R 27 582 713,07

This is not an operational budget, this is only the first step in compiling the operational budget. If you submitted this, and we could see that you did take inflation into account, we were lenient and the highest mark you could receive for this section was 1/3 (Not done/ incomplete – but we were lenient).

	Quarter 1	Quarter 2	Quarter 3	Quarter 4	Quarter 5	Quarter 6
Revenue	R 8 118 914,40	R 19 059 837,31	R 52 510 832,50	R 119 416 354,12	R 166 263 137,76	R 167 262 713,07
Cost of goods sold	R 6 840 000,00	R 16 007 500,00	R 43 987 500,00	R 99 450 000,00	R 139 152 000,00	R 139 680 000,00
Gross profit	R 1 278 914,40	R 3 052 337,31	R 8 523 332,50	R 19 966 354,12	R 27 111 137,76	R 27 582 713,07
Operating expenses	R 690 000,00	R 690 000,00	R 690 000,00	R 690 000,00	R 690 000,00	R 690 000,00
Rent	R 180 000,00	R 180 000,00	R 180 000,00	R 180 000,00	R 180 000,00	R 180 000,00
Maintenance	R 30 000,00	R 30 000,00	R 30 000,00	R 30 000,00	R 30 000,00	R 30 000,00
Insurance	R 60 000,00	R 60 000,00	R 60 000,00	R 60 000,00	R 60 000,00	R 60 000,00
Salaries	R 600 000,00	R 600 000,00	R 600 000,00	R 600 000,00	R 600 000,00	R 600 000,00
Net income	R 588 914,40	R 2 362 337,31	R 7 833 332,50	R 19 276 354,12	R 26 421 137,76	R 26 892 713,07

This is an operational budget (you did not have to have revenue and cost of goods sold). This was indicated on the discussion boards as well.

- You did not include references for your costs and the inflation rate. It is not enough to do research and to have a reference list, you need to reference your values in the document and in the budget. If you did not do this, you **could not** get 3/3 for this section (Evidence of market research to determine inflation or other changes.)
- The operational budget for each team member was the same. This is highly unlikely as each division has distinct operation cost to consider. If you did this, you got 0/3.
- The budget period is less than three years. Maximum mark obtainable is 1/3 (Estimate an operational budget for the first three years of operation).

Professionalism

- Many of you exceeded the page limit. If you did this you got 0/3 for professionalism (Page limit exceeded)
- Please also see the comments for part A's professionalism section